



ENTRY PROTOCOL

Pathways

Scope (Staff):	All staff
Scope (Area):	Pathways

CAHS commits to being a child safe organisation by applying the
National Principles for Child Safe Organisations

Read the full statement here:

[CAHS Child Safe Organisation Commitment Statement](#)

This document should be read in conjunction with this [disclaimer](#)

This protocol is currently under review to be incorporated
into the relevant Model of Care.
The content remains current throughout the review process.

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Aim

This protocol describes the entry process to Pathways Child and Adolescent Mental Health Service (CAMHS), including clear information about which children are eligible for the service and the process for facilitating access to alternative care for individuals not accepted by the service.

Risk

A child may not gain entry to a service that meets their needs in a timely manner.

Background

Pathways is a state-wide, multidisciplinary mental health service that provides comprehensive assessments, intensive therapeutic interventions, and a range of recovery-based programs. Children who access Pathways typically present with prolonged, complex mental health difficulties which may manifest in a variety of settings (including school, home and other social settings). The clinical and care needs of the children and families who access Pathways often cannot be met by the models of care offered in Tier 3 mental health services.

Pathways operates on the principles of the *Dual Continuum Model of Mental Health Care*, which describes 'mental illness' and 'mental wellbeing' as two separate but related concepts, and suggests that interventions may benefit from simultaneously targeting both the reduction of illness and improvement of well-being.

Pathways utilises the following frameworks to apply the Dual Continuum model:

- Child and family centred care;
- Recovery focused care;
- Therapeutic Crisis Intervention (TCI);
- Adolescent Mentalisation Based Integrative Treatment (AMBIT);
- Trauma informed care;
- Shared care; and
- Pharmacological treatment.

Definitions

Child: Infant, child, adolescent or young person under the age of 18.

Parent: Any parent, legal guardian, responsible family member, or other identified carer of the child.

Service suitability – general

Pathways is suitable for children who are:

- aged between six and 12 years of age; AND
- experiencing severe, complex mental health presentations, which may be evidenced by:
 - Emotional dysregulation;

- Poor family functioning;
- Attachment difficulties;
- Interpersonal difficulties;
- Developmental delay;
- School refusal;
- Self-harm or harm to others; and / or
- Poor academic performance/ specific learning difficulties; AND
- not responding to interventions used by their current treating team.

Pathways day program is not suitable for children whose difficulties are primarily related to an intellectual disability, Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD) diagnosis, or Pervasive Developmental Disorder (PDD).

Service suitability – Intensive Therapy and Recovery Day Program

The above criteria apply to all families who wish to access Pathways. To participate in the service's Intensive Therapy and Recovery Program, children must also:

- Be actively enrolled with a mainstream school. The child will be re-integrated into their usual schooling arrangement at the end of the Pathways episode of care. Where children are not enrolled in mainstream schooling, admission to the day program will be on a case by case basis in collaboration with family;
- Have a stable living arrangement, with carers who are able to commit and engage with the requirements of the programme; and
- Be capable of engaging with the content and intensive support that is offered through the Intensive Therapy and Recovery program. Children whose behaviour is highly dysregulated, or who are unable to be regulated in a reasonable amount of time, are unable to engage effectively with the day program. Children who are targeted and deliberate in their aggression (i.e. 'proactively aggressive') are also not suitable for the day program.

Children who do not meet the criteria for entry into the intensive therapy and recovery day program may be able to access other treatment options from the Pathways service (e.g. TCI for Families, assessment services).

Referral management

Pathways accepts referrals from:

- CAMHS;
- Child Development Service (CDS);
- DOE: School of Special Educational Needs (SSEN); and
- Private Psychiatrists and Paediatricians.

Pathways invite all referrers to contact the service by phone (Ph: 9382 0730) to discuss the family's suitability for the service. Following this, formal referrals should be sent to the Pathways Intake and Referral Coordinator by secure file transfer or emailed to Pathways.Admin@health.wa.gov.au. Any documentation that has already been

completed (such as the CAMHS Initial Assessment form, care planning documents, and risk assessments) can also be forwarded to support the referral.

All referrals are discussed at a weekly intake meeting. This meeting is attended by the Referral Coordinator, Pathways Head of Service, Service Manager and Day Program Coordinator. Referrals are prioritised based on clinical need and risk.

If the referral is accepted:

- Contact is made with the referrer, informing them of the outcome and inviting them to participate in a video-conference (VC) or face-to-face meeting with the Pathways team where necessary. The purpose of the meeting is to agree on treatment goals. A Case Coordinator / Specialist Clinician is allocated to the family and contact is made with the family.
- Where the child is referred by another CAMHS service:
 - The child will remain under the care of their referring service during the referral process and period of transition to Pathways. Once the child is engaged with the Pathways program, the referring service will close the child's case. After the episode of care, if the child still requires Tier 3 support, the child may be re-referred to the initial CAMHS service.
- Where the child is referred by a service external to CAMHS:
 - The child will remain under the care of their referring service during the referral process. The ongoing involvement of the referring service will be discussed and negotiated by the referrer and Pathways team based on the needs of the child and family. Where relevant, a shared care arrangement must be developed in accord with the [CAMHS Shared Care policy](#).

If the referral is not accepted by Pathways:

- Contact is made with the referrer, informing them of the outcome and providing recommendations for a more appropriate service.

Facilitating access

Pathways is located in Shenton Park and can be easily accessed by bus, train and car (with free unlimited parking on site). Due to its age, the Pathways building does not comply with all disability access requirements. However, Pathways staff are able to modify the service's model of care for families who require disabled access.

Pathways can deliver some of its services in homes, schools and other community-based settings. Any such arrangements are clearly articulated in the child's management plan.

Families who are located outside of the metropolitan area can access some components of the Pathways service via Video Conference or Telehealth. When rural and remote families are required to physically attend the Pathways site for assessment / treatment, Pathways makes every effort to book their appointments during school holiday periods. This ensures that rural and remote families do not need to make multiple trips to Perth to access care.

Though Pathways does not currently employ an Aboriginal Mental Health Worker (AMHW), Aboriginal children and families who are attending Pathways can access the support of an AMHW via other ICAMHS services. Where families have an established relationship with a ICAMHS AMHW, Pathways aims to ensure that the AMHW continues to support the

family for the duration of their episode of care with Pathways. Interpreters are available for culturally and linguistically diverse families.

Children and families attending Pathways also have the option to access a Peer Support Worker throughout the course of their treatment. These workers are specialised, non-clinical employees that complement the skills and expertise of other mental health professionals, providing a unique perspective based on direct/indirect experience (lived experience) in mental health challenges and recovery. For further information about Peer Workers in CAMHS, please see [Engaging with Peer Workers guideline](#).

Information for referrers and families about how to access Pathways is available [online](#).

Access to acute services

Pathways is not a crisis service and operates from Monday to Friday during office hours only. Information regarding emergency services is provided to families as part of their initial risk assessment and included in the child's ongoing management plan.

Consumer privacy and confidentiality

All Pathways staff receive an orientation to the service which includes an explanation of their rights and responsibilities relating to consumer privacy and confidentiality. At this time, staff are required to sign a confidentiality agreement.

Information regarding privacy and confidentiality is provided to families via the Welcome Pack and also discussed as part of the initial assessment / intake process.

Engagement with children, families and stakeholders

The Pathways Consumer Advisory Group comprises carers / consumers with experience of the Pathways service. The group provide staff with advice regarding a wide range of clinical service delivery issues. For example, the group has been involved in the review of client brochures, parent resources, and websites, and also provided advice regarding proposed parent support groups.

A Peer Support Worker is also a part of the Pathways MDT.

Demand and capacity management

When a referral is accepted for entry into Pathways, staff will determine which components of the Pathways service are best suited to the needs to the child and family at that time. This may include:

- Intensive Therapy and Recovery Program;
- Modular Assessments;
- Specialist assessments;
- Outreach (homes, schools);
- Case management; and / or
- Family Therapy.

These components may be offered concurrently or sequentially, depending on both the needs of the child and family and current service capacity. This is reviewed regularly via Pathways Multidisciplinary Team meetings.

Integration and partnership

Pathways has a Memorandum of Understanding with the Department of Education and maintains a close working relationship (which includes regular interagency meetings) with the School of Special Educational Needs.

As a part of the broader Child and Adolescent Health Service directorate, Pathways liaises regularly with Community Health and other Community and Statewide ICAMHS services, in order to facilitate timely access to and effective shared care with these services.

References and related external legislation, policies, and guidelines

[UN Convention on the Rights of the Child](#)

Related CAHS internal policies, procedures and guidelines *(if required)*

[CAMHS Engaging with Peer Workers guideline.](#)

[CAMHS Medical Record Management Procedure](#)

[CAMHS Patient Rights under the Mental Health Act Policy](#)

[CAMHS Shared Care Guideline](#)

This document can be made available in alternative formats on request.

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